My Medi-Cal sign-up checklist

Check things off as you go. You don't need every paper to start, so apply anyway. (DHCS, n.d.-e)

1 Gather your papers

- [ ] Photo ID or driver's license
- [ ] Social Security card, if you have one
- [ ] Immigration papers, if you have them
- [ ] Latest pay stub
- [ ] Last tax return (Schedule C if self-employed)
- [ ] Benefit letters, like unemployment or disability
- [ ] Receipts for child care or child support you pay

Paid in cash? You may tell the county your income yourself. (DHCS, n.d.-e)

2 Apply one way

- [ ] Online at BenefitsCal.com or CoveredCA.com
- [ ] By phone with your county office (numbers below)
- [ ] In person at your county office
- [ ] By mail with a paper application in your language

You can apply any time of year. (DHCS, n.d.-a, n.d.-e)

3 After you apply

- [ ] Open every letter and text from the county
- [ ] Send any extra proof they ask for, fast
- [ ] Find a Medi-Cal dentist (Smile, California finder)
- [ ] Send back renewal forms on time

(DHCS, n.d.-d; Smile, California, n.d.-a)

4 Kids' dental visits

- [ ] First visit by the first tooth or first birthday
- [ ] Checkup and cleaning every 6 months
- [ ] Ask about sealants for back teeth

Babies up to 3 can get exams every 3 months. (Smile, California, n.d.-a, n.d.-c)

Phone numbers

Los Angeles County DPSS	**1-866-613-3777**	Riverside County DPSS	**1-877-410-8827**
San Bernardino County TAD	**1-877-410-8829**	Medi-Cal Dental	**1-800-322-6384**
Covered California	**1-800-300-1506**	Free legal help (HCA)	**1-888-804-3536**

Scan to see what Medi-Cal covers, find a clinic and get your next step in 3 taps.

Sources (APA 7, full list on the website): California Department of Health Care Services (DHCS). (n.d.-a) Apply for Medi-Cal; (n.d.-d) Medi-Cal changes; (n.d.-e) Medi-Cal help center. Smile, California. (n.d.-a) Covered services; (n.d.-c) Covered services: Kids. Phone numbers from each county and agency's own website, retrieved November 9, 2026.

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